

NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 2 • 1569–1588**Challenges to Elizabeth at Home and Abroad, 1569–88**

HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD: The Armada Portrait of Queen Elizabeth I (c. 1588)

WOBURN ABBEY COLLECTION • BEDFORDSHIRE • WA-INV-042

Key topic 2: Challenges to Elizabeth at home and abroad, 1569–88

1 Plots and revolts at home	• The reasons for, and significance of, the Revolt of the Northern Earls, 1569. • The features and significance of the Ridolfi, Throckmorton and Babington plots. Walsingham and his spy network. • The reasons for, and significance of, the execution of Mary, Queen of Scots, 1587.
2 Relations with Spain	• Political and religious rivalry. • Commercial rivalry. The roles of John Hawkins and Francis Drake; privateering. • The significance of activities in the Netherlands, including the Dutch Revolt and the assassination of William of Orange.
3 Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88	• English involvement in the Netherlands, 1585–88, including the role of Robert Dudley. • Drake and the raid on Cadiz: 'singeing the King of Spain's beard'.
4 The Armada	• Spanish invasion plans. Reasons why Philip used the Spanish Armada. • The reasons for, and consequences of, the English victory.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 2)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

NOV 1569 • Revolt of the Northern Earls

Key Topic 2.1

Catholic Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland march on Durham Cathedral, tear up English bibles, and restore the Latin Mass with 4,600 men. Royal troops march north; the rebellion collapses and Elizabeth executes 450 rebels to crush northern disobedience.

FEB 1570 • Papal Bull *Regnans in Excelsis*

Key Topic 2.1

Pope Pius V issues a papal bull excommunicating Elizabeth, declaring her a 'pretended queen' and heretic. Crucially, the Pope releases all Catholic subjects from their oath of allegiance, making it a sacred Catholic duty to overthrow the Queen.

1571–1583 • The Ridolfi and Throckmorton Plots

Key Topic 2.1

Italian banker Roberto Ridolfi plans a Spanish invasion by the Duke of Alba to marry Mary to the Duke of Norfolk. In 1583, French Catholic Francis Throckmorton coordinates a planned invasion backed by Spain and the Pope. Walsingham uncovers both.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 2)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

AUG 1585 • The Treaty of Nonsuch & Open War with Spain

Key Topic 2.3

Following the assassination of Dutch Protestant leader William of Orange, Elizabeth signs the Treaty of Nonsuch with Dutch rebels, agreeing to send 7,400 troops under Robert Dudley. This ends decades of cold war and triggers open military conflict with Spain.

1586–FEB 1587 • The Babington Plot & Execution of Mary Stuart

Key Topic 2.1

Anthony Babington sends coded letters in beer barrels to Mary Stuart agreeing to assassinate Elizabeth. Walsingham's codebreaker Thomas Phelippes intercepts Mary's endorsement. Mary is convicted of high treason and beheaded at Fotheringhay Castle on 8 Feb 1587.

APR 1587–AUG 1588 • Drake at Cadiz & Defeat of the Spanish Armada

Key Topic 2.4

Drake raids Cadiz harbour, destroying 30 Spanish ships ('singeing the King's beard') and delaying the Armada by a year. In July 1588, 130 Spanish ships enter the Channel. English fireships break their formation at Calais; Gravelines artillery seals English victory.

Why did every Catholic plot to assassinate Elizabeth end in catastrophic failure?

Key Topic 2.1: Northern Earls, Ridolfi, Throckmorton, Babington & Walsingham's Spies

Key Specification Focus: The Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569); plots: Ridolfi (1571), Throckmorton (1583), Babington (1586); Walsingham's network of spies; execution of Mary Queen of Scots (1587).

• 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL DRILL (10 RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 10]

1. Which two northern Catholic earls led the 1569 rebellion?

2. Which Catholic cathedral did the Northern Earls seize to celebrate the Latin Mass?

3. What papal bull excommunicated Elizabeth I in 1570?

4. Which English duke was executed in 1572 for his role in the Ridolfi Plot?

5. Who was Queen Elizabeth's Spymaster General from 1573?

6. How did plotters smuggle coded messages to Mary Stuart during the Babington Plot?

7. What skilled cryptographer decoded Mary Stuart's letters for Walsingham?

8. What 1584 document pledged to execute anyone who attempted to assassinate Elizabeth?

9. In which castle was Mary, Queen of Scots beheaded on 8 February 1587?

10. Approximately how many northern rebels did Elizabeth execute after the 1569 revolt?

• CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

HISTORICAL TERMINOLOGY

Papal Bull: Key Disciplinary Concept | **Conspiracy:** Key Disciplinary Concept

Explain the difference between an official written order issued by the Pope (**Papal Bull**) and a secret agreement between people to overthrow or kill the Queen (**Conspiracy**):

Sentence Starter: *While Papal Bull established that..., Conspiracy operated differently because...*

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel June 2018 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569).

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel June 2023 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of Sir Francis Walsingham's spy network.

EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 (Q2)

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why Mary, Queen of Scots was executed in 1587.

You may use in your answer:

- The Babington Plot (1586)

- Walsingham's spy network

(You must also use information of your own.)

Task: Write your analytical response below (continue on Pages 6–7 for full timed assessment):

[Total: 12 marks]

[illegible]**TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2-3**

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 5). In Milestone 5, sketch the beer barrel with hidden cipher letters and the execution block at Fotheringhay.

Enquiry 2.1: Plots and revolts at home

NORTHERN REBELLION

1. The Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569)

- Leaders: Charles Neville (Westmorland) & Thomas Percy (Northumberland)
- Causes: Catholic devotion, political exclusion by Cecil, Mary Stuart marriage plot
- Capture of Durham Cathedral: tore up English prayer books, celebrated Latin Mass
- Failed to rescue Mary Stuart; Crown army under Sussex crushed rebellion
- Retaliation: 450 rebels executed across northern villages to terrify population

Enquiry 2.1 • Section A

CONSPIRACY INVASIONS

2. The Ridolfi & Throckmorton Plots

- Ridolfi Plot (1571): Italian banker Roberto Ridolfi, Duke of Norfolk, Spanish army under Alba
- Uncovered by Cecil; Norfolk executed on Tower Hill (1572)
- Throckmorton Plot (1583): French Duke of Guise invasion funded by Philip II
- Walsingham uncovered papers in Francis Throckmorton's home
- Bond of Association (1584): Anyone benefiting from royal murder condemned to death

Enquiry 2.1 • Section B

INTELLIGENCE & ESPIONAGE 3. The Babington Plot & Spy Network (1586) • Anthony Babington plotted with Jesuit John Ballard to assassinate Elizabeth • Secret letters smuggled to Mary Stuart inside beer barrels at Chartley • Walsingham's double agent Gilbert Gifford intercepted all letters • Cipher clerk Thomas Phelippes decoded messages and added gallows forgery • Mary's reply approving assassination provided fatal forensic proof of treason Enquiry 2.1 • Section C	
ROYAL EXECUTION 4. Execution at Fotheringhay (1587) & Verdict • Trial of Mary Stuart at Fotheringhay Castle under Act for Queen's Safety • Elizabeth's hesitation: fear of regicide backlash from France and Spain • Death warrant signed 1 Feb 1587; Council dispatched it without royal consent • Beheading of Mary Stuart on 8 February 1587 • Historical Verdict: Was Mary Stuart's execution an act of state security or judicial murder? Enquiry 2.1 • Historical Verdict	

Was war between England and Spain inevitable from the moment Elizabeth took the throne?

Key Topic 2.2: Commercial Rivalry, Privateering, Drake & Religious Conflict

Key Specification Focus: Political and religious rivalry between England and Spain; commercial rivalry in the New World; English privateering and the activities of Sir Francis Drake.

• 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL DRILL (10 RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 10]

1. Which Spanish king had previously been married to Elizabeth's sister Mary I?

2. What religion was Philip II, positioning himself as champion of the Counter-Reformation?

3. What Spanish monopoly prohibited English merchants from trading in the Americas?

4. What term describes state-licensed sea captains who raided enemy merchant ships?

5. Which English privateer became the first to circumnavigate the globe (1577–80)?

6. What famous Spanish treasure ship was captured by Drake off Ecuador in 1579?

7. How much silver and treasure did Drake capture from the *Cacafuego*?

8. Where did Elizabeth publicly knight Francis Drake in 1581?

9. Why was Philip II enraged by Elizabeth knighting Francis Drake?

10. What Dutch territory revolted against Philip II's rule in 1566?

• CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

HISTORICAL TERMINOLOGY

Privateer: Key Disciplinary Concept | **Trade Embargo:** Key Disciplinary Concept

Explain the difference between an armed sailor licensed by the Queen to capture enemy ships (**Privateer**) and a government ban that stops all trade with another nation (**Trade Embargo**):

Sentence Starter: *While Privateer established that..., Trade Embargo operated differently because...*

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel June 2019 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of commercial rivalry between England and Spain in the New World.

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel November 2021 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of Sir Francis Drake's raid on the Cacafuego (1579).

EDEXCEL JUNE 2023 (Q3A)

Score: [/ 20]

‘Commercial rivalry in the Americas was the main cause of worsening relations between England and Spain between 1569 and 1585.’ How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use in your answer: • Francis Drake's privateering • Religious conflict *(You must also use information of your own.)*

Task: Write your analytical response below (continue on Pages 10–11 for full timed assessment):

[Total: 16 marks + 4 SPaG]

[illegible]**TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2-3**

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 3). In Milestone 3, sketch Drake's ship the *Golden Hind* and the Spanish silver bars.

"Cacafuego surrendered £140,000 of treasure: Elizabeth paid off the entire national debt."

Enquiry 2.2: Relations with Spain

IMPERIAL RIVALRY 1. Commercial Rivalry in the Americas - Spanish trade monopoly in New World enforced by Philip II - English privateering: legal piracy with royal letters of marque - John Hawkins pioneered Atlantic triangular slave trade (1560s) - San Juan de Ulúa ambush (1568): Spanish fleet attacked Hawkins and Drake - Privateering transformed from commercial venture into national crusade Enquiry 2.2 • Section A	
PACIFIC RAIDS 2. Drake & The Circumnavigation (1577–80) - Drake sailed *Golden Hind* into secret Spanish Pacific waters - Raided undefended ports in Chile and Peru (Valparaíso, Callao) - Captured treasure ship *Cacafuego*: seized £140,000 in silver and gold bullion - Claimed Nova Albion (California) for Elizabeth; crossed Pacific to Moluccas - Elizabeth knighted Drake on deck at Deptford (1581), infuriating Philip II Enquiry 2.2 • Section B	

Enquiry 2.2: Relations with Spain

DUTCH REVOLT

3. Religious Conflict in the Netherlands

- Netherlands: vital trading partner for English cloth at Antwerp
- Calvinist Dutch rebels fought against Spanish Duke of Alba's repression
- Elizabeth aided Sea Beggars and allowed Dutch privateers in English ports
- 1576: Spanish Fury sacked Antwerp; Pacification of Ghent united provinces
- Duke of Parma arrived with Army of Flanders to reconquer southern provinces

Enquiry 2.2 • Section C

ESCALATION TO WAR

4. The Escalation to Formal War & Verdict

- 1580: Philip II inherited Portuguese crown and empire, doubling naval power
- 1584: Assassination of Protestant leader William of Orange
- 1584: Treaty of Joinville allied Philip II with French Catholic League
- Elizabeth faced nightmare scenario of isolated England facing united Catholic Europe
- Historical Verdict: Was war between England and Spain inevitable by 1585?

Enquiry 2.2 • Historical Verdict

Did English intervention in the Netherlands or Drake's raid on Cadiz make the Armada inevitable?

Key Topic 2.3: *The Dutch Revolt, Treaty of Nonsuch (1585), Robert Dudley & Cadiz (1587)*

Key Specification Focus: The Dutch Revolt and English involvement in the Netherlands (Treaty of Nonsuch, Robert Dudley); Drake's raid on Cadiz (1587) and "Singeing the King of Spain's Beard".

• 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL DRILL (10 RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 10]

1. Which Dutch Protestant leader was assassinated by a Catholic fanatic in 1584?

2. What treaty between Philip II and the French Catholic League was signed in 1584?

3. What 1585 treaty committed English troops to fight alongside Dutch rebels?

4. Who was appointed commander of the 7,400 English soldiers sent to the Netherlands?

5. What controversial political title did Robert Dudley accept in the Netherlands, outraging Elizabeth?

6. Which brilliant Spanish general commanded the Army of Flanders in the Netherlands?

7. In which Spanish harbour did Francis Drake launch a daring surprise raid in April 1587?

8. How many Spanish ships did Drake destroy in Cadiz harbour in 36 hours?

9. What famous phrase described Drake's raid on Cadiz?

10. What vital naval supplies did Drake destroy at Cadiz that crippled the Armada's food storage?

• CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

HISTORICAL TERMINOLOGY

Treaty of Nonsuch: Key Disciplinary Concept | **Raid on Cadiz:** Key Disciplinary Concept

Explain the difference between England's treaty promising direct military troops to Dutch rebels (**Treaty of Nonsuch**) and Drake's surprise naval attack that delayed the Spanish Armada (**Raid on Cadiz**):

Sentence Starter: *While Treaty of Nonsuch established that..., Raid on Cadiz operated differently because...*

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel June 2022 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the Treaty of Nonsuch (1585).

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel June 2019 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of Francis Drake's raid on Cadiz in 1587.

EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2020 (Q2)

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why Elizabeth signed the Treaty of Nonsuch with Dutch rebels in 1585.

(You must also use information of your own.)

[Total: 12 marks]

[illegible]**TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2-3**

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 4). In Milestone 4, sketch the Dutch Protestant rebel banner and the Treaty of Nonsuch seal.

13/24

Enquiry 2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88

TREATY ALLIANCE 1. The Treaty of Nonsuch (1585) • August 1585: Elizabeth formally committed England to open military alliance • Terms: 7,400 troops (6,400 foot, 1,000 horse) sent to the Netherlands • Crown funded war costs of £126,000 per year • Cautionary towns: Brill and Flushing handed over as English military guarantees • Significance: Direct declaration of war against the Spanish Empire Enquiry 2.3 • Section A	
MILITARY CAMPAIGN 2. Leicester's Netherlands Campaign (1585–87) • Robert Dudley, Earl of Leicester, appointed commander of English forces • Dudley accepted title of "Governor-General" of Low Countries, enraging Elizabeth • English army plagued by poor supplies, unpaid troops, and desertion • Rowland York and William Stanley betrayed English forts (Zutphen) to Spain • Leicester recalled in December 1587 having achieved minimal military progress Enquiry 2.3 • Section B	

Enquiry 2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88

CADIZ RAID 3. Drake's Raid on Cadiz (April 1587) - Elizabeth dispatched Drake with 23 ships to disrupt Spanish fleet preparations "Singeing the King of Spain's Beard": Drake sailed straight into Cadiz harbor - Destroyed over 30 Spanish war galleons and captured immense supply stores - Crucial destruction: burned thousands of seasoned wood barrel staves (food/water rot) - Delayed sailing of the Armada by over 12 months Enquiry 2.3 • Section C	
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ARMADA PREPARATIONS 4. Spanish Invasion Plans & Verdict - Philip II's grand strategy: Armada to sail up Channel to Calais - Join with Duke of Parma's 27,000 elite veteran soldiers in the Netherlands - Parma's army to cross Channel in flat-bottomed landing barges under naval escort - Flaw: Parma had no deep-water port to load troops safe from Dutch flyboats - Historical Verdict: How effective was English preemptive strategy before 1588? Enquiry 2.3 • Historical Verdict	
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Why did the Spanish Armada fail: superior English tactics or disastrous Spanish planning?

Key Topic 2.4: Spanish Invasion Plan, Ship Design, Fireships at Calais & Battle of Gravelines

Key Specification Focus: The Spanish invasion plan and leadership of Medina Sidonia; English naval design (Hawkins) and artillery; fireships at Calais; the Battle of Gravelines (1588); the reasons for the Armada's defeat.

• 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL DRILL (10 RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 10]

1. How many ships sailed in the Spanish Armada in May 1588?

2. Who was appointed Commander-in-Chief of the Spanish Armada by Philip II?

3. What veteran Spanish army in the Netherlands was the Armada supposed to collect?

4. Who served as Lord High Admiral commanding the English fleet in 1588?

5. What naval treasurer revolutionized English galleon design with lower forecastles?

6. What long-range naval cannon allowed English ships to bombard Spanish galleons from safety?

7. What defensive formation did the Spanish Armada maintain sailing up the Channel?

8. What terrifying tactic did the English use at midnight on 7 August off Calais?

9. What decisive naval battle was fought on 8 August 1588 off the Flemish coast?

10. What route were the surviving Spanish ships forced to take back to Spain?

• CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

HISTORICAL TERMINOLOGY

Galleon: Key Disciplinary Concept | **Fireships:** Key Disciplinary Concept

Explain the difference between a large, heavily armed warship designed for ocean fighting (**Galleon**) and burning vessels sent into the Spanish fleet to cause panic and scatter their formation (**Fireships**):

Sentence Starter: *While Galleon established that..., Fireships operated differently because...*

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel November 2020 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of the Spanish invasion plan of 1588.

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel June 2024 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the English fireship attack at Calais (7 August 1588).

Enquiry 2.4: The Armada

FLEET LOGISTICS

1. Fleet Strength & Medina Sidonia

- Spanish Armada: 130 ships, 2,431 guns, 30,000 men (led by Duke of Medina Sidonia)
- Medina Sidonia: experienced administrator but lacked sea combat experience
- Spanish strategy: tight defensive crescent formation, board enemy ships with infantry
- English fleet: 200 ships (led by Lord Howard of Effingham and Francis Drake)
- Hawkins' design: "race-built" galleons (faster, lower in water, more manoeuvrable)

Enquiry 2.4 • Section A

CHANNEL BATTLES

2. The Channel Running Battle (July 1588)

- 29 July: Armada sighted off the Lizard, Cornwall; English fleet left Plymouth
- Spanish crescent formation held firm past Plymouth, Portland Bill, and Isle of Wight
- English long-range culverin artillery inflicted minimal structural damage
- Spanish ammunition spent heavily without closing for boarding combat
- 6 August: Armada anchored at Calais Roads waiting for Parma's army

Enquiry 2.4 • Section B

Enquiry 2.4: The Armada

GRAVELINES DECISION 3. Calais Fireships & Battle of Gravelines • Midnight 7 August: English launched 8 fireships packed with pitch and gunpowder into Calais • Panic: Spanish captains cut anchor cables; crescent formation broken permanently • 8 August: Battle of Gravelines: English ships closed to 100 yards • Rapid-fire culverins pounded drifting Spanish galleons; 5 ships sunk, 1,000+ killed • Spanish gunners poorly trained; mismatched cannonballs jammed guns Enquiry 2.4 • Section C	
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PROTESTANT WIND 4. The Atlantic Retreat & Historical Verdict • South-westerly gale drove Armada north into dangerous North Sea waters • Medina Sidonia forced to navigate perilous route around Scotland and western Ireland • Lacking anchors and fresh water, over 40 Spanish ships wrecked on Atlantic reefs • Thousands of Spanish survivors slaughtered or drowned on Irish beaches • Historical Verdict: Did English tactics, Spanish blunders, or the weather defeat the Armada? Enquiry 2.4 • Historical Verdict	
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NAVAL TACTICS & STRATEGIC MAP • THE SPANISH ARMADA (1588)

1. THE STRATEGIC ROUTE OF THE ARMADA: PLYMOUTH TO GRAVELINES & THE ATLANTIC RETREAT			
① The Channel (July): 130 Spanish ships in tight crescent formation sail past Plymouth and the Isle of Wight. English long-range fire inflicts minor damage.	② Calais Roads (7 Aug): Armada anchors waiting for Parma. Midnight English fireships scatter Spanish fleet, forcing captains to cut anchor cables.	③ Gravelines (8 Aug): Close-range artillery duel. English race-built galleons pummel drifting Spanish ships with rapid-fire culverins; 5 galleons sunk.	④ The Retreat (Aug–Sept): South-westerly gales drive Armada around Scotland and Ireland. Lacking anchors, over 40 ships wreck on Atlantic reefs.
2. NAVAL ARCHITECTURE: HAWKINS' RACE-BUILT GALLEON VS THE SPANISH IMPERIAL CARRACK			
GB English Race-Built Galleon (*Revenge*, *Ark Royal*) • Designer: Sir John Hawkins (Treasurer of the Navy) • Hull Design: Lower forecastles and aftercastles; streamlined hull for superior speed, maneuverability, and pointing into the wind • Armament: Armed with long-range bronze culverins mounted on compact four-wheeled truck carriages • Gunnery Doctrine: Trained gun crews could reload and fire broadsides rapidly from standoff range, avoiding boarding combat • Tactical Goal: Batter enemy hulls and rigging from safe artillery distance		ES Spanish Imperial Galleon / Carrack (*San Martín*) • Commander: Duke of Medina Sidonia • Hull Design: High towering wooden forecastles and sterncastles designed as floating wooden fortresses for infantry • Armament: Heavy short-range cannon and demi-cannon mounted on clumsy two-wheeled field carriages • Gunnery Doctrine: Soldiers fired muskets from high castles while gunners reloaded outside ship hulls (extremely slow) • Tactical Goal: Grapple enemy ships, board with veteran Spanish infantry, and capture vessels in hand-to-hand combat	

MASTER KNOWLEDGE ORGANISER • KEY TOPIC 2: CHALLENGES TO ELIZABETH AT HOME AND ABROAD, 1569–88

1. CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY & CONCEPTUAL DEFINITIONS	
• Papal Bull (1570): *Regnans in Excelsis*: Pope Pius V excommunicated Elizabeth, releasing subjects from loyalty. • Bond of Association (1584): Pledge by Englishmen to execute anyone involved in an assassination attempt against Elizabeth. • Singeing the King's Beard: Drake's April 1587 raid on Cadiz harbour destroying 30 ships and delaying the Armada by a year. • Culverin: Long-range English bronze naval cannon mounted on truck carriages for rapid reloading.	• Privateering: State-licensed raiding of enemy merchant shipping by armed private vessels holding letters of marque. • Treaty of Nonsuch (1585): Official military alliance committing 7,400 English soldiers under Robert Dudley to aid Dutch rebels. • Galleon: A large, multi-decked warship designed for ocean navigation and long-range cannon fire. • Battle of Gravelines (1588): Decisive naval clash off Flanders where English artillery battered scattered Spanish warships.
2. ESSENTIAL CHRONOLOGY	3. KEY HISTORICAL FIGURES MATRIX
• 1569: Revolt of the Northern Earls • 1570: Papal Bull excommunicates Queen • 1571: Ridolfi Plot uncovered • 1577–80: Drake circumnavigates world • 1583: Throckmorton Plot uncovered • 1584: Treaty of Joinville (Spain/France) • 1585: Treaty of Nonsuch signed • 1586: Babington Plot ciphers cracked • Feb 1587: Mary Stuart executed • July–Aug 1588: Spanish Armada defeated	• Sir Francis Walsingham: Principal Secretary & Spymaster General; uncovered Ridolfi, Throckmorton, and Babington plots. • Sir Francis Drake: Privateer, navigator, and vice-admiral; raided Cadiz in 1587 and commanded at Gravelines. • Duke of Medina Sidonia: Spanish grandee appointed by Philip II to command the 130 ships of the Armada. • Duke of Parma: Brilliant general commanding Spain's 27,000-man veteran Army of Flanders. • Anthony Babington: Catholic gentleman whose coded letters to Mary Stuart triggered her trial and execution. • Sir John Hawkins: Treasurer of the Navy; designed English race-built galleons and developed naval gunnery.

GRADE 9 EXAM TECHNIQUE MASTERCLASS • PEARSON EDEXCEL PAPER 2 RUBRICS

1. THE 2/2 MARK FORMULA: DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 • TARGET: 2 / 2

Mark Scheme Law: 1 mark for identifying a valid feature + 1 mark for supporting historical detail.

Grade 9 Model Answer: "One key feature of the Act of Supremacy (1559) was that it made Elizabeth Supreme Governor of the Church of England [1 mark]. Specifically, this title was chosen as a compromise to appease both Catholics who believed only the Pope was head of the Church, and Puritans who believed Christ was the only head [1 mark]."

2. THE 12/12 MARK FORMULA: EXPLAIN WHY [12 MARKS • 18 MINS]

EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 • TARGET: 11–12 / 12 (LEVEL 4)

Three PEEL Paragraphs: Use both provided stimulus points + introduce at least ONE distinct self-selected knowledge point. Every paragraph must feature explicit causal reasoning words (*Consequently, As a direct result, This meant that*).

Level 4 Linking Formula: Do not just list reasons! Connect them causally: "*This economic grievance did not operate in a vacuum; rather, it directly exacerbated religious fear because...*"

3. THE 16/16 MARK FORMULA: EVALUATIVE ESSAY [16 MARKS + 4 SPAG • 25 MINS]

EDEXCEL JUNE 2022 • TARGET: 15–16 / 16 (LEVEL 4)

Criteria-Led Judgment Architecture:

- **Introduction:** Define the key terms, state your overarching thesis, and establish your criteria for judgment (e.g. short-term threat vs long-term structural instability).
- **Paragraph 1 (Agree with Statement):** Rigorously analyze the stated factor with precise dates, statistics, and historical names.
- **Paragraphs 2 & 3 (Counter-Arguments):** Introduce other critical factors (including required own-knowledge beyond the stimulus points).
- **Conclusion:** Weigh the factors comparatively! Never write "both were important". Explain why one factor was the foundational catalyst while another was merely a symptom.

★ **Examiner Secret:** High-scoring Level 4 candidates establish explicit criteria in the first two sentences: "*In evaluating this statement, success must be judged by whether the policy achieved long-term institutional stability or merely temporary crisis containment...*"

Section B: Question 3 • Evaluative Essay [16 Marks + 4 SPaG • 25 Mins]

'The main reason for the defeat of the Spanish Armada was poor Spanish leadership.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

Stimulus: • The Duke of Medina Sidonia • English fireships at Calais *(You must also use information of your own.)*

Remember to introduce additional knowledge beyond the stimulus (e.g. John Hawkins' race-built galleons, long-range culverins, or the Protestant Wind).

Quick PEEL Plan: Point 1: _____ | Point 2: _____ | Point 3 (Own Knowledge): _____

THE HISTORY DEPARTMENT • ASSESSMENT & PROGRESS RECORD

KEY TOPIC 2 ASSESSMENT & PROGRESS RECORD

PUPIL: 	TARGET GRADE:	PREDICTED:	ATTITUDE: 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5
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#	ENQUIRY / LESSON ASSESSMENT	DO NOW (10M)	Q1(A) (2M)	Q1(B) (2M)	EXT (12/16M)	LESSON TOTAL
1	Enquiry 2.1: Plots and revolts at home	[/ 10]	[/ 2]	[/ 2]	[/ 12]	[/ 26]
2	Enquiry 2.2: Relations with Spain	[/ 10]	[/ 2]	[/ 2]	[/ 16]	[/ 30]
3	Enquiry 2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88	[/ 10]	[/ 2]	[/ 2]	[/ 12]	[/ 26]
4	Enquiry 2.4: The Armada	[/ 10]	[/ 2]	[/ 2]	[/ 16]	[/ 30]
KEY TOPIC 2 CUMULATIVE ASSESSMENT TOTALS		Do Now: [/ 40]	Q1(a): [/ 8]	Q1(b): [/ 8]	Ext: [/ 56]	[/ 112]

PEARSON EDEXCEL PAST PAPER PROVENANCE • COMPLETED EXAM YEAR LEDGER					
#	ENQUIRY / TOPIC FOCUS	Q1(A) FEATURE [2M]	Q1(B) FEATURE [2M]	EXT WRITING [12/16M]	YEAR DONE
1	Enquiry 2.1: Plots and revolts at home	Edexcel June 2018 (Q1b)	Edexcel June 2023 (Q1b)	Edexcel June 2018 (Q2)	[/]
2	Enquiry 2.2: Relations with Spain	Edexcel June 2019 (Q1a)	Edexcel November 2021 (Q1b)	Edexcel June 2023 (Q3a)	[/]
3	Enquiry 2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88	Edexcel June 2022 (Q1a)	Edexcel June 2019 (Q1b)	Edexcel November 2020 (Q2)	[/]
4	Enquiry 2.4: The Armada	Edexcel November 2020 (Q1b)	Edexcel June 2024 (Q1a)	Edexcel June 2019 (Q3b)	[/]

TEACHER FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT • WWW / EBI FEEDBACK	Effort Grade: [/]
WHAT WENT WELL (WWW):	
EVEN BETTER IF (EBI):	
Teacher Signature: _____	Date: ____/____/2026

INTERACTIVE DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • SCAN FOR INSTANT 20-QUESTION RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Scan with smartphone camera to launch live self-marking quizzes

KT 2.1	KT 2.2	KT 2.3	KT 2.4	KT 2 VAULT
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